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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN AND CHICKEN PRODUCTS COOKED, DEHYDRATED

This limited coordination Military specification has been prepared by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Command (GL), Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information, but it has not been approved for promulgation as a coordinated revision of Military Specification MIL-C-43135F. It is subject to modification. However, pending its promulgation as a coordinated Military specification, it may be used in procurement.

This specification is approved for use by Defense Personnel Support Center, Department of Defense, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cooked, freeze-dehydrated chicken and chicken products for use by the Armed Forces as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1):

Types

I - Chicken pieces
II - Chicken stew

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Natick Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDNA-TDS, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8905

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

C-M-350	-	Milk, Nonfat Dry
L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
N-S-541	-	Starches, Edible
EE-B-575	-	Bouillon (Soup and Gravy Bases)
EE-M-591	-	Monosodium Glutamate
EE-S-631	-	Spices: Ground and Whole and Spice Blends
PP-C-248	-	Chickens, Chilled and Frozen (Ready-to-cook)
TT-C-495	-	Coating, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans
JJJ-O-1866	-	Onions and Garlic Dehydrated
PPP-B-26	-	Bag, Plastic, (General Purpose)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-C-843	-	Cushioning Material, Cellulosic
PPP-C-1797	-	Cushioning Material, Resilient, Low Density, Unicellular, Polypropylene Foam
PPP-T-60	-	Tape, Packaging, Waterproof

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-101	-	Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials: Test Procedures
FED-STD-595	-	Colors

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MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668	-	Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

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(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Poultry and Edible Products Thereof and United States Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service, Agricultural Marketing Service, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

VISUAL INSPECTION GAUGE (METAL) FOOD CONTAINERS

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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AMERICAN PUBLIC HEALTH ASSOCIATION

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

U.S. PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., Mack Publishing Company, 20th and Northhampton Sts., Easton, PA 18042.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20402.)

AMERICAN DRY MILK INSTITUTE, INC.

Standards for Grades of Dry Milks Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc., 130 N. Franklin Street, Chicago, IL 60606.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 So. Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), the contractor shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3.4 and 6.6).

3.2 Material. All material shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign and undesirable odors, flavors, and extraneous materials. All materials shall be such and shall be so handled and processed that the final product shall conform to the end product requirements. End item requirements for moisture, fat, and bacteriological requirements as specified in 3.4.2 and 3.4.3 shall be as applicable, notwithstanding any requirements in the individual material specification.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall meet the commodity requirements for type I or IV, class 1 or 2, style 1 through 5 of PP-C-248. Identity of bird type, age, quality and wholesomeness will be certified by the U.S. Department of Agriculture. When chicken parts are used they shall be used in their natural proportions (light-dark meat) except that white meat may be used in excess of natural proportions. If type IV frozen chickens are used, they shall have been maintained during storage at a temperature of 0°F (-18°C), or lower and shall have been properly packaged and wrapped so as to avoid freezer burn or other damage. The poultry shall not have been in frozen storage longer than 120 days prior to thawing for use in the product. The product shall be in excellent condition and shall show no evidence of thawing or refreezing.

3.2.2 Carrots. Carrots shall be either fresh or frozen complying with 3.2.2.1 or 3.2.2.2 as applicable.

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3.2.2.1 Carrots, frozen. Frozen carrots shall comply with the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots. The frozen carrots shall be mechanically diced and the dicer settings should be approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm).

3.2.2.2 Carrots, fresh. Fresh carrots shall be washed, peeled, sorted, trimmed and blanched in accordance with good commercial practice. The fresh carrots shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm).

3.2.3 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall comply with the requirements of JJJ-O-1866.

3.2.4 Monosodium glutamate. Monosodium glutamate shall comply with the requirements of EE-M-591.

3.2.5 Nitrogen. The nitrogen shall meet the requirements of the Pharmacopoeia of the United States and, in addition, shall be water or liquid nitrogen pumped.

3.2.6 Milk, dry, nonfat. Nonfat dry milk shall comply with the requirements of C-M-350.

3.2.7 Onions, dehydrated. Dehydrated onions shall comply with the requirements for type I, style 4 (minced) of JJJ-O-1866.

3.2.8 Peas, frozen. Frozen peas shall meet the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas. Peas shall be slit or perforated to improve rehydration characteristics.

3.2.9 Pepper, white. White pepper shall comply with the requirements for type II of EE-S-631.

3.2.10 Potatoes. Potatoes shall be one of the following varieties: Russet, Burbank, Kennebec, Green Mountain, Cobbler, Red McClure, Sebago, Katahdin or Snowflake. The potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled, trimmed to remove defects, and mechanically diced with dicer setting at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm) before being cooked. The potatoes shall be processed according to good commercial practice. Dehydrated or dehydro frozen potatoes shall not be used.

3.2.11 Poultry seasoning. Poultry seasoning shall comply with the requirements of EE-S-631.

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3.2.12 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, free flowing sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

3.2.13 Soup and gravy base, chicken-flavored. Chicken flavored soup and gravy base shall comply with the type II requirements of EE-B-575.

3.2.14 Starch, pregelatinized, edible. Instant starch shall comply with the commodity requirements for type II of N-C-541.

3.2.15 Vegetable oil. The vegetable oil shall be a bland flavored, winterized, bleached, deodorized corn oil. The oil shall be stabilized with butylated hydroxyanisole or butylated hydroxytoluene or both in equal amounts. Total quantity of stabilizer shall be 0.02 percent maximum by weight of the oil.

3.3 Processing.

3.3.1 Chicken.

3.3.1.1 Preparation. In addition the raw chicken meat following preparation (see 3.2.1) shall meet the following requirements:

(a) The carcass or parts shall be skinned and raw boned.
(b) There shall be no heads, feet, metacarpus - phalanges sections of wings, giblets, or viscera.
(c) There shall be no bones, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
(d) There shall be no ligaments, tendons or cartilage exceeding 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
(e) There shall be no ground or comminuted chicken meat.

The chicken meat shall not have been frozen more than three times including final freezing for dehydration. Any intermediate stage of preparation necessitating holding of the product within limits specified in table I shall require prompt cooling to 40°F (4°C) or below. Preparation, cooking, dicing, formulation and dehydration shall be conducted so that the final dry product shall comply with the finished product requirements of 3.4.

3.3.1.2 Cooking and dicing. The chickens or parts shall be cooked in suitable casings or metal molds by any suitable means until tender. A minimum internal temperature of 170°F (77°C) shall be reached during the cooking process. Salt may be used in the preparation of the cooked chicken but shall not exceed a total of 1.25 percent in the cooked product. If salt is used, the formula for type II product shall be adjusted to compensate for the added salt. If the cooked, boned chicken meat is to be held or shipped before dicing it shall be stuffed

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tightly into casings. If frozen meat is used, or fresh meat is frozen during any stage of preparation and holding, it shall not be thawed and refrozen more than twice before it is to be used in the formulation of the final product (see also 3.3.1.1). However, tempering the frozen meat to a temperature of not more than 30°F (-1°C) to facilitate dicing shall not be considered thawing, provided that the diced product is placed in a freezer at 0°F (-18°C) or lower immediately after dicing. The chicken meat shall be diced by machine with dicer settings adjusted to approximately 1 by 1 by 3/8 inches (25 by 25 by 10 mm) for type I product and 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/4 inches (13 by 13 by 6 mm) for type II product.

3.3.1.3 Dehydration. The chicken shall be freeze dehydrated at an absolute pressure not to exceed 1.5 millimeters (0.2 kPa) of mercury and a product temperature as indicated by suitable instruments, not to exceed 150°F (66°C). If the platen temperature is maintained at 155°F (68°C) or below with radiant heating, the product temperature may be disregarded. After dehydration is completed, the pressure shall be equalized to atmospheric level with nitrogen, and the product shall be packaged immediately as specified in 5.1. If it becomes necessary to hold the product more than 2 hours between dehydration and packaging, the product shall be adequately protected from oxygen and moisture by either holding under a nitrogen atmosphere with 2.0 percent or less oxygen, or under a vacuum of at least 27 inches of mercury (9.8 kPa absolute pressure) for the entire period. If vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen.

3.3.2 Type I product (chicken pieces). Type I product shall be prepared by freezing and freeze drying the diced chicken.

3.3.3 Type II product (chicken stew). Chicken stew shall be prepared in accordance with the following formula: 1/

	Percent by weight
Chicken, cooked, diced	20.0
Potatoes, diced, raw	25.1
Peas, slit or perforated	6.5
Carrots, diced	8.0
Vegetable oil	2.5
Water	32.5
Gravy mix	5.4
	100.0

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Gravy mix

Soup and gravy base, chicken flavored	27.78
Poultry seasoning	0.24
Monosodium glutamate	0.11
Nonfat dry milk	33.66
Starch, instant	33.66
Pepper, white	0.67
Garlic powder	0.10
Onions, dehydrated	3.78
	100.00

1/ The total amount of the salt in the formula shall equal 1.25 percent. If sufficient salt is not contributed by the chicken, soup and gravy base and monosodium glutamate then salt shall be added to the formula as necessary to bring the total salt level to 1.25 percent.

Gravy mix ingredients and water shall be mixed thoroughly. Peas, carrots potatoes, and oil shall be added and the mixture heated to a minimum of 185°F (85°C) while stirring, until tender. Stirring shall be gentle enough so that the cooked vegetables are not broken up. The diced chicken shall be added and the mixture heated to a minimum of 180°F (82°C). Any process which produces an equivalent product shall be acceptable. The prepared product shall be spread on dehydrator trays, frozen and freeze dehydrated.

3.3.4 Time and temperature limitations. The products shall be so handled as to comply with table I.

TABLE I. Time and temperature limitations for handling and storage of component chicken and chicken meat 1/

Stage	Maximum holding period	Maximum temperature
Chilled chicken or chicken meat		
Stage 1		
a. From preparation (3.3.1.1) to completion of cooking. 2/	72 hours	40°F (4°C)
b. After cooling, in rolls, or logs, to start of dicing.	72 hours	40°F (4°C)
c. Between dicing and freeze dehydration of type I product or formulation of type II product.	48 hours	40°F (4°C) 3/
d. After formulation, before freezing for dehydration (type II).	24 hours	40°F (4°C)
e. Total time - all stages combined (preparation, cooking, dicing and formulation before freezing for dehydration).	8 days (type I) 9 days (type II)	

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TABLE I. Time and temperature limitations for handling and storage of component chicken and chicken meat 1/ (cont'd)

Stage	Maximum holding period	Maximum temperature
Frozen chicken or chicken meat (after preparation and cooking, see stage 1a, above)		
Stage 2		
a. Total freezer time - all stages combined (raw, cooked and diced).	60 days	0°F (-18°C)
Cooked rolls or logs.	45 days	0°F (-18°C)
After dicing.	15 days	0°F (-18°C)
b. Between dicing and freeze dehydration of type I product or formulation of type II product.	30 days 4/	0°F (-18°C)
c. Between frozen prepared products and placement of same in the dehydrator (applicable to type II product).	5 days	0°F (-18°C)
Stage 3 (in transit)		
d. Maximum internal temperature of frozen raw or cooked meat at the completion of any transit between plants (product shall be placed in 0°F (-18°C) or lower freezer immediately upon receipt).	-	10°F (-12°C)

1/ The various increments of time specified for each stage of handling or processing are given to permit maximum flexibility to the contractor and to the processor. At no stage shall the quality of the product show any evidence of deterioration in its organoleptic properties.

2/ Following cooking, internal product temperature of 40°F (4.°C) or less, when chilling is intended, shall be reached within 24 hours; if product is to be frozen, internal temperature of 0°F (-18°C) or less shall be reached within 48 hours.

3/ Maximum temperature permissible for tempering in preparation for dicing as specified in 3.3.1.2.

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4/ The key word is "dicing". Example: Of the total 60-day maximum permitted under 2(a), if the rolls are diced within 10 days of manufacture, it is necessary to process the diced chicken within a 30-day period, even if the total of 60 days has not elapsed.

3.4 Finished product.

3.4.1 Physical characteristics.

3.4.1.1 Type I chicken pieces. The dehydrated, cooked chicken pieces shall meet the following requirements:

(1) Not more than 10 percent by weight of the product shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 3-1/2 sieve with moderate shaking so as to permit all undersized pieces to drop through the sieve without injury to the larger intact pieces. No product retained on a screen with 1-inch (25 mm) holes shall have a dimension larger than 1-1/8 inches (29 mm).

(2) There shall be no harmful foreign material (visible to the unaided vision) visually determined to be metal, glass, hard plastic, wood splinters, other hard materials, chemicals, paint or insect parts.

(3) There shall be no foreign material of a type used in the processing such as casing or string.

(4) There shall be no evidence of thawing in the dehydrator such as glazed surface areas measuring more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in any dimension or dark colored areas of any dimension.

(5) There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as damp or soggy areas.

(6) There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.

(7) There shall be no cartilage or sections of tendons or ligaments more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.

(8) At least 50 percent by weight of the product shall be light meat.

(9) When rehydrated with an excess of hot water (180 to 200°F) (82 to 93°C) for 20 minutes, the product shall show complete water penetration. Since gristle, gelatinous material, and connective tissue frequently tend to impede proper rehydration, callous-like areas ascribable to these conditions will not be considered evidence of improper rehydration.

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(10) The rehydrated product shall possess flavor, odor and texture in ranges considered normal for freeze-dried product of the same type. The product shall be free from scorched, burned or foreign flavors or odors.

(11) The texture of the rehydrated product shall be in a range considered normal for roasted or steamed, freeze-dried chicken of comparable class and type.

3.4.1.2 Type II, chicken stew. The dehydrated chicken stew shall comply with the following physical characteristics:

(1) There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, glass or paint.

(2) There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as damp or soggy areas.

(3) There shall be no soft extraneous material of the type used in processing (paper, string, casing material, etc.) or smears and stains which have an aggregate area of more than that of a circle 1/2-inch (13 mm) in diameter.

(4) When rehydrated in hot water 180° to 200°F (82 to 93°C) using the ratio of 13 ounces (384 ml) of water to 4 5/8 ounces (131 g) of dehydrated chicken stew for 10 minutes, the product shall show complete water penetration through all dice and particles. However, callous-like areas ascribable to gristle, gelatinous material, and connective tissue hindering rehydration in the chicken shall not be considered evidence of improper rehydration.

(5) The rehydrated chicken stew shall possess flavor, odor and texture in ranges considered normal for freeze dehydrated chicken stew. The product shall be free from scorched, burned or foreign flavors or odors.

(6) The rehydrated chicken stew shall show distinct dice of chicken, carrots, potatoes and whole peas.

3.4.2 Analytical requirements. Product shall comply with the following analytical requirements on a unit basis:

	Percent maximum		
Type	Moisture	Fat	Oxygen 1/
I	2.0	23.0	2.0
II	2.0	---	2.0

1/ In headspace gas when gas packed.

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3.4.3 Microbiological requirements. The finished dry product shall have a aerobic plate count of not more than 75,000 per gram, and shall be negative per gram for E. coli.

3.5 Plant qualification. The product shall originate, be processed, marked and handled in plants which are operated under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. Finished product refrigeration facilities (freezer, storage and shipping) not operating under these regulations shall meet the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.5.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and material shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1.1 Examination of chicken. Examination of the chicken shall be made in accordance with the examination criteria of the referenced specification in 3.2.1 to determine conformance to the pertinent commodity requirements contained therein and to determine conformance to the condition and identity requirements of 3.2 and 3.2.1. Records of all applicable control data (temperature and storage time) shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more condition or identity requirements or to temperature and storage requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable. Conformance to the identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of USDA certificate.

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4.3.1.1.1 Identification of defects. Identification of defects found during examination shall be as shown below. Lot size shall be expressed as the number of chickens or pounds (kilograms) of chicken. The sample size for examination shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-3. The sample unit shall be one chicken or one pound (kg) as applicable. The AQL shall be 2.5 for the Major B defects and 10.0 for Minor defects expressed as defects per hundred units.

Examination of Chicken

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
151		Not skinned or raw boned.
152		Presence of head, feet, matacarpus - phalanges section of wings, giblet or viscera.
153		Presence of bone, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension. 1/
	201	Presence of ligaments, tendons or cartilage exceeding 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
154		Presence of ground or comminuted chicken meat.

1/ Measure to a tolerance of 1/8-inch (millimeter).

4.3.1.2 Examination of garlic powder, monosodium glutamate; pregelatinized starch, milk, dry, nonfat; onions, dehydrated; pepper, white; poultry seasoning, and soup and gravy base, chicken flavored. Each of the ingredients shall be examined to determine conformance to 3.2 and to the finished product requirements in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications, except that the sampling plans and acceptance criteria shall not apply. The sample for examination shall be an approximate 1-pound (454 g) composite for nonfat dry milk and an approximate 4-ounce (113 g) composite for each of the other ingredients, derived from five primary containers, or all containers if five or less form a lot. The amount of product for sieve examination as applicable, shall be as specified in the pertinent component specification.

4.3.1.3 Examination of frozen carrots and peas. Examination of frozen carrots and peas shall be made to determine compliance with the condition requirements of 3.2 and grade requirements of 3.2.2.1 and 3.2.8. The sample for condition examination shall be a 10 pound (4.5 kg) composite derived from five

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primary containers or all containers if less than five form a lot. Examination for the grade requirement shall be ascertained by the examination of labels, invoices, grade certificate or other valid documents. In addition, the peas shall be examined to determine the slit or perforated requirements of 3.2.8. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot, or end item as applicable.

4.3.1.4 Examination of fresh carrots, potatoes, salt and vegetable oil. Examination shall be made to determine the condition requirements of 3.2 and the applicable identity and condition requirements of the pertinent product paragraph. The sample unit for examination of the condition requirements shall be 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of carrots or potatoes and 1-pound (454 g) of salt and 1-quart (0.95 liter) of vegetable oil. Determination of compliance to the identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. Nonconformance to one or more of the above requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot or end item as applicable.

4.3.1.5 Examination of nitrogen. Examination of labels, invoices and similar documents shall be made to determine compliance with requirements of 3.2.5. Nonconformance to requirements of 3.2.5 shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient, and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the component or the involved quantity of finished product.

4.3.1.6 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification shall be as shown in table II. Results shall be applicable to the lot average except for laminated plastic-foil bag material which shall be both lot average and unit requirements and for cans for which the average for tin plating applies separately to top ends, bottom ends, and bodies. Nonconformance to test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE II. Testing of components 1/

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported to	Test ref. and rqmts. para.
Cans and lids 2/	One can and lid	Cans	S-1	Tin plate	Nearest 0.01 lb/ base box	4.5.3.4 5.1.1
Polyethylene bag	One bag	Bags	S-1	Thickness 3/	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	4.5.3.5 5.1.2.1 4.5.1.4
				Seal strength	Nearest 1/4 lb. (0.01 kN/m)	5.1.2.1 4.5.3.3

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TABLE II. Testing of components 1/ (cont'd)

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported to	Test ref. and rqmts. para.
Cooked chicken component	8 oz. (227 g) composite	Pounds (kg)	4/	Salt	Nearest 0.01 percent	3.3.1.2 4.5.2.4
Plastic foil laminated bag material	Bag or sheet	Bags or sheets	S-1	Seal strength	Nearest 1/4 lb. (0.01 kN/m)	5.1.2.2 5.1.2.2.1 4.5.3.3
Ionomer				Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.1.2.2
Aluminum				Thickness	Nearest 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm)	5.1.2.2 4.5.1.4
Polyethylene				Weight	Nearest 1 lb. (kg)	5.1.2.2
Polyester or nylon 6				Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	5.1.2.2 4.5.1.4
Tape	Roll	Rolls	S-1	Tensile strength	Nearest pound (0.1 kN/m)	5.1.2.1 4.5.3.6
Baseboard	Board	Boards	S-1	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.1.2.1.2 4.5.3.7

1/ See 4.3.3.

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2/ Exterior can coating, when required, and can label shall be tested in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications except that tests shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tinplate testing with additional cans as required to complete the sampling plan of TT-C-495.

3/ In lieu of testing for thickness requirement determination may be made by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. Nonconformance to thickness requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ The composite shall be derived from five primary containers or all containers if less than five form a lot.

4.3.2 In-process examination. Process examination shall be made to determine compliance with the formulation requirements and with the requirements pertinent to processing procedures, controls and equipment of 3.3, except for the requirements of 3.3.1.1, and with the applicable requirements of 5.1.2.1.1. Records shall be maintained reflecting formulations, pressure, time, and temperature. Nonconformance to requirements as determined by actual examination or as reflected by the records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product.

4.3.3 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables IV through IX and 4.3.3.1 through 4.3.3.4. The inspection levels and AQLs for the tables shall be as shown in table III. AQLs shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, for tables IV, V, VI, and VIII and as percent defective for tables VII and IX.

TABLE III. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLS		
				Major A	Major B	Minor
IV	I	One primary container	Primary containers	0.25	1.5	6.5
V	S-2	One bag	Bags	-	2.5	6.5
VI	S-3	One bag	Bags	-	1.5	6.5
VII	S-3	One primary container	Primary containers	-	-	2.5
VIII	S-2	Contents of one primary container	Primary containers	1/	1.5	6.5
IX	S-3	One primary container	Primary containers	-	0.65	-
X	S-3	One shipping container	Shipping containers	-	1.5	6.5

1/ See footnote 1/ to table VIII.

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TABLE IV. External examination of container 1/

Category			Defect		
Major A	Major B	Minor		Can (603 by 700)	Poly-ethylene bag
101			False seam or improperly closed	X	X
102			Tear, hole or cut	-	X
	151		Pitted rust 2/	X	-
	152		Not type, size or style specified	X	X
	153		Severe dent	X	-
	154		Cable cut	X	-
	155		Tape missing or tape not holding bag in place as specified	-	X
	156		Dent causing sharp ridge	X	-
	157		Severe panelling, buckled or collapsed can	X	-
	158		Not clean (bag)	-	X
		201	Moderate dent	X	-
		202	Not clean (can) 3/	X	-

1/ Visual Aids for Inspection of Metal Containers may be used as a guide to the classification of can defects.

2/ Rust that can be removed by wiping with a soft cloth will not be considered as pitted rust.

3/ Cans with a very thin film of grease which is discernible to the touch but not readily discernible visually are considered to be clean.

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TABLE V. Examination of polyethylene and laminated foil bag 1/

Category		Defect		
Major B	Minor	(Applicable prior to filling and sealing)	Polyethylene bag, tape and bag base-board	Laminated plastic-foil bag
151		Not style or material specified	X	X
152		Three edges not heat sealed		X
153		"V" or "U" shaped notch exceeds 1/8 inch (3 mm) or less than 1/16 (2 mm) inch 2/		X
154		"V" or "U" shaped notch not 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) ± 1/8 inch (3 mm) from open end of bag 2/		X
155		Name of product missing, incorrect or illegible		X
	201	Other markings missing, incorrect or illegible		X
156		Color of label white or other than dull non-reflecting color		X
157		Printing not bold black face or indelible ink 3/		X
	202	Label not affixed as specified		X
	203	Lip does not extend 1/4 inch (6 mm) beyond outer edge (when applicable) 2/		X

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TABLE V. Examination of polyethylene and laminated foil bag 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect		
Minor B	Minor	(Applicable prior to filling and sealing)	Polyethylene bag, tape and bag base-board	Laminated plastic-foil bag
	204	Tape missing or not placed over ears (when applicable, see 5.1.2.1)	X	
		Applicable to baseboard		
	205	Baseboard material not as specified	X	
	206	Not a natural color ranging from brown to gray when applicable	X	
	207	Not dimension specified	X	
	208	Corners not rounded	X	

1/ Bag dimensions are inside dimensions exclusive of seams or seals. Deviations from bag dimensions due to seal creep, or seams not being parallel with each other shall be scored as a defect.

2/ Measure to a tolerance of 1/16 inch (2 mm).

3/ When applicable, determination of compliance to the indelible ink requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents.

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TABLE VI. Examination of the polyethylene and laminated foil bag after filling and sealing

Category		Defect		
Major B	Minor		Polyethylene bag	Laminated foil bag
151		Not formed as specified	X	X
152		Broken, sifter, tear or hole	X	X
	201	Maximum thickness exceeds 2-1/4 inches (57 mm) at any point 1/		X
	202	Not folded as specified		X
153		Not clean	X	X
154		Seal closure width less than 5/16-inch (8 mm) or more than 1/2-inch (13 mm) 2/		X
155		Double closure seal width less than 5/16-inch (8 mm) 2/		X
	203	Tear notch not below closure seal		X

1/ Measure to a tolerance of 1/4-inch (6 mm).

2/ Measure to a tolerance of 1/32-inch (1 mm).

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TABLE VII. Examination of filled and sealed can or bag for net weight 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Minor		Contents of can or bag less than (ounces)
201	Type I	19-3/4 (560 g)
202	Type II	4-1/2 (128 g)

1/ Results shall be reported to a tolerance of 1/8 ounce (3 g) for cans and to a tolerance of 1/32 ounce (1 g) for bags.

2/ The lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates the lot average net weight is less than the specified net weight.

TABLE VIII. Examination of finished product 1/

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	Dehydrated product
101			Presence of foreign material, such as but not limited to glass, paint, insect or insect parts, dirt or presence of foreign material of a type used in the processing such as casing or string.
102			Presence of scorched, burned or foreign flavors, smear or stains with an aggregate area of more than a 1/2-inch (13 mm) circle and odors in rehydrated product (see applicable rehydrating instructions in 3.4.1).
103			Presence of chemical odor.
		201	Product retained on a screen with 1-inch (25 mm) holes with a dimension larger than 1-1/8 inches (29 mm) (type I product).
	151		More than 10 percent by weight passes through a U.S. Standard No. 3-1/2 sieve with moderate shaking (type I product), (see 3.4.1.1, item 1). 2/

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TABLE VIII. Examination of finished product 1/ (cont'd)

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	Dehydrated product
	152		Evidence of incomplete dehydration, e.g., damp or soggy areas.
	153		Evidence of thawing in the dehydrator, i.e., presence of glazed surface areas measuring more than 1/2-inch (13 mm) in any dimension or presence of dark colored areas of any dimension. 2/
	154		Bone pieces measuring more than 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension. 2/
		202	Cartilage or section of tendon or ligament more than 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension. 2/
	155		Less than 50 percent by weight is light meat (type I product only). 2/
			Rehydrated product (see 3.4.1.1 or 3.4.1.2 as applicable)
	156		Product not completely rehydrated. 3/
	157		Type II product does not show distinct dice of chicken, carrots, potatoes and whole peas.
	158		Does not possess flavor, odor and texture in range considered normal for freeze dried products of applicable type. 4/
			Vegetables
	159		Not completely rehydrated.

1/ Finding of one or more Major A defects shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Report percent to the nearest whole number and linear measurements to a tolerance of 1/16-inch (3 mm).

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3/ Dry or callous-like areas attributable to gristle, gelatinous material and connective tissue in the chicken meat shall not be considered as defects.

4/ Presence of burnt or foreign flavor or odor shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE IX. Examination for leakage and delamination

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Steady progression of bubbles (applicable to cans). 1/
152	Delamination (applicable to bags).

1/ See 4.5.1.1 for procedure.

4.3.3.1 Examination of can labeling. Can labeling shall be examined in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-1497.

4.3.3.2 Examination of can coating. Examination of can coating when required shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of TT-C-495.

4.3.3.3 Examination of the filled and sealed shipping container. Examination of the filled and sealed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the applicable examination criteria contained in the appendix to PPP-B-636. In addition the following defects shall be included in the table of examination: Major: Markings, missing, incorrect or illegible. Minor: Arrangement not as specified. When packing for level C is required to be in accordance with 5.2.4, examination shall be in accordance with table X.

TABLE X. Examination of packing (Applicable to level C, Flexible Packages)

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
151		Not material specified (see 5.2.4).
	201	Less than 44 packages (see 5.2.4). 1/
152		Liner missing.

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TABLE X. Examination of packing (Applicable to level C, Flexible Packages) (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
153		Pad or pads missing.
	202	Arrangement not as specified.
154		Marking missing, incorrect or illegible.
	203	Excess package material not maintained in the flat (unfolded) state.
155		Dunnage material not as specified (see 5.2.4).
	204	Dunnage material not placed as specified.
	205	Dimensions of dunnage material not as specified (see 5.2.4). 2/
	206	Top or bottom pads missing or not constructed of same material as shipping container.

1/ Lot shall be rejected if the average count is less than the specified count.

2/ Report length and width dimensions to a tolerance of one inch (mm) and thickness to a tolerance of 1/16 inch (mm) for 1/8 inch (3 mm) material and to a tolerance of 1/32 inch (mm) for the 1/16 inch (2 mm) material (measure to the nearest millimeter).

4.3.3.4 Examination of unit loads. When applicable, examination of unit loads shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-35078.

4.3.4 First article inspection. First article samples of the product which the contractor intends to furnish shall be inspected to assure compliance with 3.4.

4.4 Sampling procedures and acceptance criteria for testing of the finished product. The finished product (dehydrated form) shall be tested for moisture, fat (type I only), and headspace oxygen in sealed cans and for microbiological content in accordance with the requirements of 3.4.2 and 3.4.3. Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.5. Test requirements shall be applicable

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to the sample unit. The sample unit for testing shall be one filled and sealed primary container for types I and II product. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers, and the sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. The AQL, expressed as percent defective for each characteristic, shall be 1.5. A nonconformance to a test requirement shall be scored as a defect. Results for moisture, fat and oxygen shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent, and microbiological counts shall be reported in accordance with Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products.

4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Examination procedures.

4.5.1.1 Leakage (cans). The filled and sealed container shall be examined for leakage by submerging in water, contained in a desiccator or other suitable container and maintaining a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) (6.7 kPa absolute pressure) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as leakers.

4.5.1.2 Examination for loss of vacuum of flexible food packet. The evacuated packets shall be examined on a one hundred percent basis to determine compliance with the vacuum requirements of 5.1.2.2.1. The examination shall be made not less than 24 hours after sealing. Nonconformance to the vacuum requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the individual packet (see 4.5.1.3). Records shall be maintained to reflect the one hundred percent examination and results thereof. Nonconformance to this requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.1.3 Visual examination for loss of vacuum in food packet. During the examination the package shall continue to exhibit a tight adherence of the bag to the surface contours of the contents along the seams when a force is applied away from the contents at the center of each side seam (holding each side seam between thumb and forefinger of each hand, simultaneously exert a slight pull with both hands). Repackaging of the product into a new laminated foil-plastic bag will be permitted provided that the repackaging and resealing is accomplished within 7 days of the original sealing.

4.5.1.4 Packet material nominal tolerances. The permissible variation of the computed or measured thicknesses from the stated requirements shall be as follows:

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a. Polyethylene bag - plus or minus ten percent.

b. Plastic foil laminated bag:

(1) 0.0025-inch (0.0635 mm) ionomer - plus or minus ten percent.

(2) 0.00035-inch (0.0089 mm) aluminum foil - tolerance; ± 10 percent from stated requirements.

(3) 10 pound (4.5 kg) polyethylene - tolerance; ± 10 percent from stated requirements.

(4) 0.001-inch (0.0254 mm) thick polyester or Nylon 6 - tolerance; ± 20 percent of stated requirements.

4.5.2 Test procedures.

4.5.2.1 Oxygen. Oxygen in the headspace gas (cans) shall be determined in accordance with Standards for Grades of Dry Milks Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916. A 500 ml flask may be used.

4.5.2.2 Moisture. Moisture in the product shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists; Chapter: Meat and Meat Products: Section: Meat; Method: Moisture-Drying in Vacuum. Use a temperature of 70°C for 16 hours under a pressure of 13 kPa (100 mm Hg).

4.5.2.3 Fat. Fat determination shall be made in accordance with Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat; Method: Crude Fat or Ether Extract (using petroleum ether as solvent).

4.5.2.4 Salt. Chemical analysis for salt shall be in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat; Test: Salt (sodium chloride); Method: Salt.

4.5.3 Microbiological testing. Microbiological testing of the product shall be made, as applicable, in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Microbiological Methods, Section: Examination of Frozen, Chilled, Precooked, or Prepared Foods - Official First Action, except as specified in 4.5.3.1 and 4.5.3.2.

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4.5.3.1 Preparation and dilution of the food homogenate. The finished product shall be prepared for chemical and microbiological testing by being adequately comminuted, care being taken to avoid contamination of product and moisture pickup. A representative sample shall then be removed and handled as specified in 4.5.3.1.1 and as described in 4.5.3.2.

4.5.3.1.1 Following addition of the diluent to the dry product, allow to stand for 15 minutes before blending. Continue as directed by AOAC.

4.5.3.2 E. coli. Transfer 1 ml of the 1:10 dilution prepared in 4.5.3.1 into each of 10 tubes of Lauryl Sulfate Tryptose (LST) broth. Incubate LST tubes at 35° ± 1°C for 48 ± 2 hours. Examine tubes for gas formation at 24 and 48 hour intervals. With a 3 mm loop, transfer a loopful of broth from each positive LST tube displaying gas into a tempered EC broth fermentation tube. Conduct EC test at 45.5° ± 0.2°C as directed by the AOAC. EC tubes displaying gas production are considered positive for fecal coliforms. A single EC positive culture shall constitute rejection when confirmed to be E. coli types I (++--) or II (-+--) by the IMViC testing procedure, using above referenced AOAC procedure.

4.5.3.3 Seal strength test (polyethylene and plastic-foil bags). Seal strength shall be tested in accordance with the procedure specified in Method B of ASTM Designation D 882. Seal specimens shall be 1/2-inch or 1-inch (13 or 25 mm) in width and shall be pulled at a uniform rate of 10 inches (254 mm) per minute. Readings shall record tensile strength at time of seal break. Two nonadjacent specimens shall be taken from each of the three manufacturer's seals (bottom seal only of the polyethylene bag) of the bag to be tested, and the average of the specimens shall represent the seal strength of the bag tested. The seal strength of the processor's closure seal shall be determined in the same manner.

4.5.3.4 Tin coating weights. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

4.5.3.5 Thickness of polyethylene. Thickness of polyethylene shall be determined by the method described in L-P-378.

4.5.3.6 Testing of tape. Testing of tape shall be in accordance with the criteria of PPP-T-60.

4.5.3.7 Thickness of baseboard. Thickness of baseboard shall be determined in accordance with Method 1003 of FED-STD-101.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1), and in the type of package specified.

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5.1.1 Level A cans. A net weight of 20 ounces (567 g) of type I product shall be filled into a size 603 by 700 open top style, round, metal can, with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double seamed ends. A minus 1/4-ounce (6 g) tolerance will be allowed in any one container provided the average net weight of the cans is not less than 20 ounces (567 g). The cans shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25-pound commercial electrolytic tin plate per base box (see 4.5.3.4) and shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495. The product shall be packaged under an atmosphere of nitrogen. The filled and sealed cans shall not leak when tested in accordance with 4.5.1.1.

5.1.2 Level A, flexible packages (type II). The product shall be packaged in polyethylene bags as specified in 5.1.2.1. These shall then be overpackaged in laminated bags as specified in 5.1.2.2.

5.1.2.1 Polyethylene bags. A net weight of 4-5/8 ounces (131 g) of type II product shall be filled into a polyethylene bag of 0.005-inch (0.127 mm) thickness ± 10 percent. A minus 1/8-ounce (3 g) tolerance will be allowed in any one bag provided the average net weight of the bags is not less than 4-5/8 ounces (131 g). The polyethylene material for the bag shall be made in accordance with type I, grade A bags of PPP-B-26, except that the bag shall be made from food grade polyethylene. It shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product and shall be approved by the Food and Drug Administration for food items. The seal strength of the manufacturer's seal shall be not less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) (lot average) when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.3 with no individual unit evidencing a seal strength of less than 4 pounds per linear inch (25.4 mm) (0.70 kN/m). The inside dimensions of the bag shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 by 8 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension) (140 by 89 by 203 ± 3 mm) with the open end of the bag having the 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch (140 by 89 mm) dimensions. After filling, the end panels of the bag (corresponding to the 3-1/2 inch (89 mm) dimension) shall be folded in to form gussets, and the bag shall be closed by folding over its open end. Where required by the bulkiness of the product, the bulk of the contents within the bag shall be compressed to a depth of not more than 2 inches (51 mm) by applying a constant uniform pressure over the entire top surface of the product. The filled bag with its open top folded over to prevent spillage of the product shall be inserted to the bottom of the laminated plastic-foil bag specified in 5.1.2.2. Alternatively, in lieu of polyethylene bags conforming to type I, of PPP-B-26, bags made in accordance with type II, of PPP-B-26, with inside dimensions of 9 by 8 inches ± 1/8 inch (229 by 203 ± 3 mm) in each dimension with the open end of the bag having the 9 inch (229 mm) dimension, may be used. The material and seal strength shall be as specified for type I bags. When type II bags are used, they shall be formed over a baseboard on a mandrel as specified in 5.1.2.1.1 before filling. While the bag is positioned on the mandrel, the two bag ears shall be taped

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down over a 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch (140 by 89 mm) baseboard constructed in accordance with 5.1.2.1.2. An 8 inch (203 mm) long strip of 1 inch (25 mm) wide tape complying with type III, class 2 of PPP-T-60 except that the minimum wet or dry tensile strength for the longitudinal direction shall be 18 pounds per inch width (3.15 kN/m) and 20 pounds per inch width (3.50 kN/m) for the transverse direction and shall be applied across both ears to fasten them securely to the baseboard.

5.1.2.1.1 Mandrel. The mandrel face shall be 5-3/8 by 3-3/8 inches (137 by 86 mm) and the height shall be not less than 12 inches (305 mm). All corners and edges of the mandrel shall be rounded and all surfaces finished to prevent damage to the bag material.

5.1.2.1.2 Baseboard. The baseboard shall be constructed from unbleached and uncoated solid sulfate or sulfite paperboard not less than 0.022 inch (0.559 mm) thick, Alternatively, the baseboard may be constructed from 0.022 inch (0.559 mm) thick food grade paperboard made from recycled fibers. If paperboard made from recycled fibers is used, it shall be natural color ranging from brown to gray. The baseboard shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inches (140 by 89 mm) (± 1/8 inch) (2 mm) and shall have all corners rounded to form a smooth contour.

5.1.2.2 Laminated plastic-foil bag. The bag shall be fabricated from a material consisting of 0.0025-inch (0.0635 mm) thick ionomer or polyethylene film (± 10 percent) laminated or extrusion coated to 0.00035-inch (0.0089 mm) thick aluminum foil, laminated on the plain side to 0.001-inch (0.0254 mm) thick polyester or Nylon 6. The polyester or Nylon 6 shall be bonded to the aluminum foil by hot extruding 10 pounds (4.5 kg) per ream of polyethylene between the laminae. The exterior (polyester or Nylon 6) surface of the material shall be colored overall with a color in the number ranges from 34052 to 34108 inclusive, or 20045, 20062 or 30045 of FED-STD-595. Reverse printing of the exterior layer will be acceptable and any luster contributed by the polyester or Nylon 6 lamina (external) shall not be considered as affecting the color gloss. The combined sheet material shall show no evidence of delamination before or after heat sealing. The laminated material shall be suitable formulated for food products in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regualtions Promulgated Thereunder. The interior surface of the laminated material shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product. The bag shall be a flat style bag having the inside dimensions of 6 (152 mm) by 10-5/8 inches (270 mm) (± 1/8 inch (3 mm) in each dimension), and shall be heat sealed on three edges with 3/8-inch (10 mm) wide seals (± 1/16 inch) (2 mm). One side of the open end of the bag may be provided with a 1/4 inch (± 1/16 inch) (6 mm ± 2 mm) extended or fold over lip to facilitate opening and filling. The laminated bag material shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds (2.7 kg)

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per linear inch and no individual sample shall test less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.3. A "V" or "U" shaped tear notch, cut not to exceed 1/8-inch (3 mm) in depth (-1/16 inch) (-2 mm) shall be made in both side seals 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) (±1/8-inch) (3 mm) from the open (unsealed) end of the bag. The package shall be closed as specified in 5.1.2.2.1.

5.1.2.2.1 Closure of filled laminated plastic-foil bag. The filled laminated bag shall be evacuated and closed by heat sealing the open end in a vacuum of not less than 28 inches (i.e., 2 inches or less of mercury pressure) (6.4 kPa absolute pressure) as registered on a vacuum gauge on the closing machine. After a storage period of 24 hours or more following the package closing operation, an examination shall be made of each package to determine compliance with the vacuum requirements (see 4.5.1.3 for procedure). The closure seal shall be not less than 5/16 inch (8 mm) nor more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) wide and shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch (1.05 kN/m) with no individual seal strength specimen testing less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.3. Alternatively, an optional double seal may be applied to close the bags. The double closure seal shall be at least 5/16-inch (8 mm) wide and shall be above the tear notch and shall have a seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch (1.05 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.3. If thermal impulse sealing is used for the closure, a seal width of not less than 1/8-inch (3 mm) is required. The package shall be labeled in accordance with 5.4.2, subsequent to the closing operation. Packages which are improperly sealed or fail to maintain vacuum after sealing may be resealed or the contents may be placed in a new laminated plastic-foil bag and resealed.

5.1.3 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Six size 603 by 700 cans of the product, arranged three in length, two in width and one in depth shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1). The style RSC shipping container may be top-opening or end-opening. Flexible packages shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.4.

5.2.1 Level A packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-SL, V2s, of PPP-B-636. When unit loading is specified the sleeve and reinforcement are not required.

5.2.2 Level B packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.2.4 Level C packing (for shipment of flexibly packaged food to the ration assembler. Forty five filled and sealed food component packages, made as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a fiberboard box with liner, complying with style RSC-L, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 175, of PPP-B-636. In addition, top and bottom pads constructed of the same material as the shipping container shall be used in packing. The packages shall be packed flat or nested in three layers of 15 packages each. Each package shall be packed with its excess package material maintained in the flat (unfolded) state. Dunnage material not less than 1/8-inch (3 mm) thick conforming to type II, class b of PPP-C-843, or, alternatively, dunnage material not less than 1/16 inch (2 mm) thick conforming to PPP-C-1797, shall be placed between each of the three layers of packages and in the bottom and top of the cases to minimize movement of each individual packet. The length and width of the pieces of dunnage material shall be not less than the length and width of the shipping container.

5.3 Unitized loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unitized loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and, in addition, shall contain the following information:

Name of product
List of ingredients
Net weight
Directions for use
GAS PACKED

5.4.1.1 Directions for use (cans). The following directions for use, as applicable, shall be lithographed on the body or on one end of the can:

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Type I - Chicken pieces

Chicken pieces	1 can (20 ounces)
Water, hot (180° - 200° F)	3-3/4 quarts
Salt	2 tablespoons

Place hot water in container. Add salt.

Add contents of can to hot water.

Stir, cover, and let stand 20 minutes or longer.

Drain.

Use in any recipe requiring cooked, diced chicken.

For salad, refrigerate at once in a small-sized covered container and use at the next meal.

Substitute 20 ounces (1 can) cooked dehydrated chicken for 12-1/2 pounds fresh chicken, ready-to-cook, or 3-1/3 pounds fresh chicken, cooked and boned.

5.4.2 Directions for use (packet bags). Each sealed package shall be labeled by means of a pressure-sensitive label. The label shall be colored a dull non-reflective color other than white, and all printing thereon shall be black, boldface, legible type with indelible ink. The label shall be applied to one face of the bag with sufficient pressure to assure its adherence to the packet. The labels shall contain the following information:

CAUTION - INNER BAG IS OPEN ON ONE SIDE

REMOVE IT CAREFULLY HOLDING OUTER BAG UPRIGHT TO AVOID SPILLING CONTENTS

NAME OF PRODUCT (AS APPLICABLE)

USDA INSPECTION MARKING (AS APPLICABLE)

TEAR BAG OPEN AT NOTCHES

ADD 1/2 CANTEEN CUP HOT OR COLD WATER TO FOOD IN BAG.

LET SOAK ABOUT 5 MINUTES. ADD MORE WATER IF DESIRED.

MAY BE EATEN DRY.

NET WT. 4-5/8 AVD. OZ. (131 g)

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER

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5.4.2.1 Alternative printing on packet bags. Alternatively the above information may be printed directly on the bag with permanent black ink. When printing is applied directly to the bag it shall be located in an area that will permit the printing to be legible after vacuum sealing.

5.4.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.4 Unitized loads. Unitized loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type of product required (see 1.2).
(c) When a first article is required (see 3.1).
(d) Type of package required (see 5.1).
(e) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is required.
(g) When PPP-C-1797 material is desired (see 5.2.4).
(h) Type and class of unitized load when unitized loading is specified.

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D or DSAR 4145.7.

6.3 Intended use of nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. Packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations and specific overseas operations.

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this document to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.5 Award of contracts. Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.5 and 4.2.

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6.6 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article shall be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of 12 cans or polyethylene bags. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.7 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice and are for information only. (Copies may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA 19103). In each instance, the value stated in U.S. customary units shall be controlling.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-A931

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-C-0043135C(GL) - CHICKEN AND CHICKEN PRODUCTS COOKED, DEHYDRATED

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

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